

Homework 6, Week 7

Activity 6

ACTIVITY 6

Identify the fallacies in the following cause-and-effect statements.

1. Over the course of several weeks the needles from the pine trees along the Wombat River fell into the water. Shortly thereafter, many dead fish washed up on the river banks. The owners of the Wombat River Chemical Company claimed that it was obvious that the pine needles had killed the fish.

Fallacy: _____

136 Writing Critically 2

2. The Republicans pass a new environment reform law. Shortly thereafter, the economy takes a nosedive. The Democrats claim that the reform caused the economic woes and they push to get rid of it.

Fallacy: _____

3. According to a recent report, married people with no children have 20% more disposable income than those with children. This shows that it is affluence that causes declining birth rates.

Fallacy: _____

4. A dam is built, and a year later earthquakes and severe droughts occur frequently to the city near the dam. People conclude that the dam must be the cause of all those misfortunes.

Fallacy: _____

1. Ignoring the common cause
2. Post hoc
3. Confusing the cause and the effect
4. Post hoc

Activity 9

ACTIVITY 9

Read the following two paragraphs and point out the topic sentence and details in each paragraph. Then check if the details support the topic sentence.

1. 1) When you use a euphemism because of your sensitivity for someone's feelings or out of concern for a recognized social or cultural taboo, it is not doublespeak.
- 2) For example, you express your condolences that someone has "passed away" because you do not want to say to a grieving person, "I'm sorry your father is dead."
- 3) When you use the euphemism "passed away," no one is misled. 4) Moreover, the euphemism functions here not just to protect the feelings of another person, but to communicate also your concern for that person's feelings during a period of mourning. 5) When you excuse yourself to go to the "restroom," or you mention that someone is "sleeping with" or "involved with" someone else, you do not mislead anyone about your meaning, but you do respect the social taboos about discussing bodily functions and sex in direct terms. 6) You also indicate your sensitivity to the feelings of your audience, which is usually considered a mark of courtesy and good manners.

Topic sentence: _____

Details: _____

Supportive or not: _____

If not, please specify which sentence(s) is/are distracting.

Topic sentence

The first sentence.

Details

1. The expression of "passed away".
2. The effects of the expression.
3. The other expressions of euphemism.
4. The effects of these expressions.

Supportive or not

They are supportive since the details as the examples to state the topic that the euphemism are not only the protection of others but also the concern to others.

2. 1) Much of the violence we see in the world today may be caused by the emphasis on violence in the media. 2) More often than not, the front page of the local newspaper contains stories involving violence. 3) In fact, one recent issue of my local newspaper contained seven references to violent acts. 4) There is also violence in public school systems. 5) Television reporters frequently hasten to crime and accident scenes and film every grim, violent detail. 6) The other day, there was a drive-by shooting downtown. 7) If the media were a little more careful about the ways in which they glamorize violence, there might be less violence in the world today and children would be less influenced by it.

Topic sentence: _____

Details: _____

Supportive or not: _____

If not, please specify which sentence(s) is/are distracting.

Topic Sentence

The first sentence

Details

1. The front page of newspaper often contains violence.
2. The violence in public school systems.
3. The television often hasten the violence.
4. The incident of shooting.
5. Emphasis the effects of the media to the violence.

Supportive or not

The sixth sentence does not support the topic sentence since the topic is the media hasten the spread of the violence but the sentence does not mention media. The other details support the topic sentence very well.

Text A

Americans and the Land

John Steinbeck

1. I have often wondered at the **savagery** and thoughtlessness with which our early settlers approached this rich continent. They came at it as though it were an enemy, which, of course it was. They burned the forests and changed the rainfall; they swept the **buffalo** from the plains, **blasted** the streams, set fire to the grass, and ran a **reckless scythe** through the **virgin** and noble **timber**. Perhaps they felt that it was limitless and could never be exhausted and that a man could move on to new wonders endlessly. Certainly there are many examples to the contrary, but to a large extent the early people **pillaged** the country as though they hated it, as though they held it temporarily and might be **driven off** at any time.
(Introduce the topic that Americans destroy the land they are living on like the enemy)
2. This tendency toward irresponsibility persists in very many of us today; our rivers are poisoned by reckless dumping of **sewage** and toxic industrial wastes, the air of our cities is **filthy** and dangerous to breathe from the **belching** of uncontrolled products from **combustion** of coal, coke, oil, and gasoline. Our towns are **girdled** with **wreckage** and the **debris** of our toys—our automobiles and our packaged pleasures. Through uninhibited spraying against one enemy, we have destroyed the natural balances our survival requires. All these evils can and must be overcome if America and Americans are to survive; but many of us still

conduct ourselves as our ancestors did, stealing from the future for our clear and present profit. ***(State Americans has the tendency of irresponsibility to the land and pollute due to the profit)***

3. Since the river-polluters and the air-poisoners are not criminal or even bad people, we must presume that they are **heirs** to the early **conviction** that sky and water are **unowned** and that they are limitless. When the first settlers came to America and dug in on the coast, they **huddled in** defending villages **hemmed** in by the sea on one side and by endless forests on the other, by Red Indians and, most frightening, the mystery of an unknown land extending nobody knew how far. And for a time very few dared to find out. On the East Coast, and particularly in New England, the colonists farmed **meager** lands close to their communities for safety. After a time, however, brave and forest-wise men drifted westward to hunt, to trap, and eventually to bargain for the furs which were the first precious negotiable wealth America produced for trade and export. Then trading posts were set up as centers of collection and the exploring men moved up and down the rivers and crossed the mountains, made friends for mutual profit with the Indians, learned the wilderness techniques, so that these explorer-traders soon dressed, ate, and generally acted like the **indigenous** people around them. ***(Introduce the history of the colonists to the land of America and their destruction to the land)***
4. For a goodly time the Americans were travelers, moving about the country collecting its valuables, but with little idea of permanence; their roots and their hearts were in the towns and the growing cities along the eastern edge. Then the trickle of immigrants became a stream, and the population began to move westward—not to grab and leave but to settle and live, they thought. The newcomers were of **peasant** stock, and they had their roots in a Europe where they had had landless, for the possession of land was the requirement and the proof of a higher social class than they had known. In America they found beautiful and boundless land for the taking—and they took it. ***(Show that the colonists settled down, became the mainstream and got the resource from the land of America)***
5. It is little wonder that they went land-mad, because there was so much of it. They cut and burned the forests to make room for crops; they abandoned their knowledge of kindness to the land in order to maintain its usefulness. When they had cropped out a piece they moved on, raping the country like invaders. The topsoil, held by roots and freshened by leaf-fall, was left helpless to the spring **freshets**, stripped and **eroded**. With the **naked** bones of clay and rock exposed. The destruction of the forests changed the rainfall, for the searching clouds could find no green and **beckoning** woods to draw them on and milk them. The merciless 19th century was like a hostile **expedition** for **loot** that seemed limitless. Countless buffalo were killed, stripped of their hides, and left to **rot**, a **reservoir** of permanent food supply eliminated. More than that, the land of the Great Plains was robbed of the **manure** of the herds. Then the **plows** went in and **ripped off** the protection of the buffalo grass and opened the helpless soil to quick water and slow drought and the **mischievous** winds that **roamed** through the Great Central Plains. There has always been more than enough desert

in America; the new settlers, like **overindulged** children, created even more. ***(The specific deeds of the colonists in 19th century to destroy the environment of America)***

6. The railroads brought new **hordes** of land-crazy people, and the new Americans moved like **locusts** across the continent until the western sea put a boundary to their movements. Coal and copper and gold drew them on; they savaged the land, gold-rugged the rivers to skeletons of **pebbles** and debris. ***(The new Americans continued to expand the land to the boundary and they dug the mines)***
7. It was full late when we began to realize that the continent did not stretch out to infinity; that there were limits to the industries to which we could subject it. Engines and heavy mechanical equipment were allowing us to **ravage** it even more effectively than we had with fire, dynamite, and gang plows. Conservation came to us slowly, and much of it hasn't arrived yet. Having killed the whales and wiped out the sea **otters** and most of the **beavers**, the market hunters went to work on game birds; ducks and **quail** were **decimated**, and the passenger pigeon eliminated. The Pacific Coast **pilchards** were once the raw material for a great and continuing industry. We hunted them with aircraft far at sea until they were gone and the canneries had to be closed. In some of the valleys of the West, where the climate makes several crops a year available, which the water supply will not justify, wells were driven deeper and deeper for irrigation, so that in one great valley a million acre feet more of water was taken out than rain and melting snow could replace, and the water table went down and a few more years may give us new desert. The great redwood forests of the western mountains early attracted attention. These ancient trees, which once grew everywhere, now exist only where the last Ice Age did not wipe them out. And they were found to have value. The **loggers** went through the great **groves** like a **barrage**, felling the trees—some of which were two thousand years old—and leaving no maidens, no seedlings or **saplings** on the **denuded** hill. ***(It was late that Americans realized that the environmental resources and many aspects that have been destroyed)***
8. In the early times we were impressed and awed by the fantastic accidents of nature, like the Grand Canyon and Yosemite and Yellowstone Park. The Indians had revered them as **holy** places, visited by the gods, and all of us came to have somewhat the same feelings about them. Thus we set aside many areas of astonishment as publicly owned parks; and though this may to a certain extent have been because there was no other way to use them, as the feelings of preciousness of the things we had been destroying grew in Americans, more and more areas were set aside as national and state parks, to be looked at but not injured. Many people loved and were in awe of the redwoods; societies and individuals bought groves of these wonderful trees and presented them to the state of preservation. ***(More and more areas became natural parks and attracted more and more people)***
9. No longer do we Americans want to destroy **wantonly**, but our new-found sources of power—to take the burden of work from our shoulders, to warm us, and cool us, and give us light, to transport us quickly, and to make the things we use and wear and eat—these power sources **spew** pollution on our country, so that the rivers and streams are becoming

poisonous and lifeless. The birds die and the lack of food; a **noxious** cloud hangs over our cities that burns our lungs and redden our eyes. Our ability to conserve has not grown with our power to create, but this slow and **sullen** poisoning is no longer ignored or justified. Almost daily, the pressure of outrage among Americans grows. We are no longer content to destroy our beloved country. We are slow to learn; but we learn. When a super-highway was proposed in California which would **trample** the redwood trees in its path, an **outcry** arose all over the land, so **strident** and fierce that the plan was put aside. And we no longer believe that a man, by owning a piece of America, is free to outrage it. ***(The rapid development of technology make the environment more polluted and the author state the status nowadays)***

Significant Words and Phrases

- savagery
The trait of cruelty
- buffalo **#CET6**
a type of animal, bull
- blast **#CET4** **#CET6**
explode
- reckless **#CET6**
careless
- scythe
a type of tool to cut grass
- virgin **#CET6**
being used or worked for the first time
- timber **#CET4** **#CET6**
wood
- pillage
rob
- drive off **#CET4** **#CET6**
make something away
- sewage
polluted water
- filthy
messy
- belching
the gas

- combustion
a process of burn
- girdle
a belt surrounding the waist
- wreckage #CET4 #CET6
something that has been ruined
- debris #CET6
something that has been broke up
- heir #CET4 #CET6
someone inherit the things from their parents
- conviction #CET6
judge someone criminal
- unowned
without master
- huddle in #CET4 #CET6
gathering together due to frighten
- hem
edge
- meager
poor
- indigenous #CET6
local
- peasant #CET4 #CET6
farmer
- freshet
flood
- erode #CET6
deteriorate
- naked #CET4 #CET6
uncovered
- beckoning #CET6
appealing
- expedition #CET6
adventure
- loot #CET6
rob
- rot #CET6
decay

- reservoir #CET6
a large lake storing water
- manure
material from animals or plants to hasten the growth of crops
- plow #CET4 #CET6
a farm tool to break the soil
- rip off #CET4 #CET6
deceive
- mischievous
harmful
- roam
wander
- indulge #CET6
give free rein to
- horde
a crowd of
- locust
a type of insect eating the crops
- pebble
stone
- ravage
destroy
- otter
a type of animal
- beaver
also a type of animal
- quail
a type of bird
- decimate
kill
- pilchard
a type of fish
- logger
a person who fells trees
- grove
a small growth of trees
- barrage
a lot of things

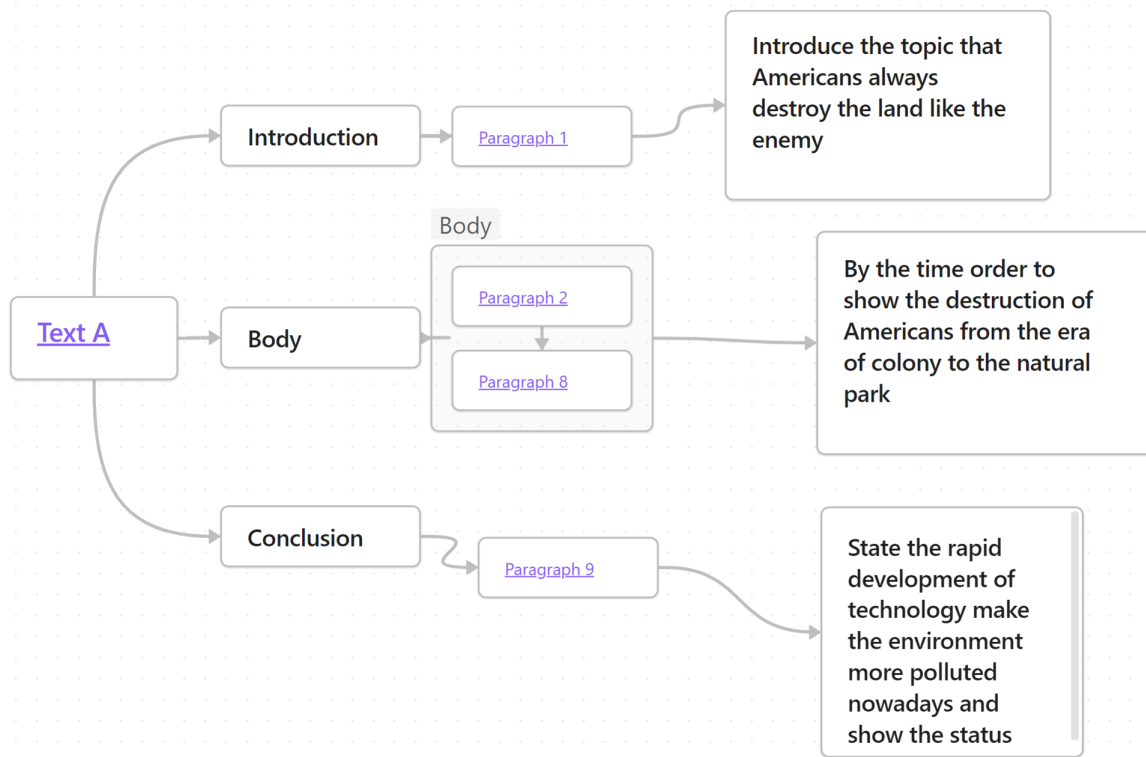
- sapling
young tree
 - denude
deprive; make bare
 - wantonly
freely without bound
 - spew
spring out
 - noxious
harmful
 - sullen
angry
 - trample
walk on something
 - outcry
protest
 - strident
harsh
-

Topic Idea

The article criticizes that the Americans destroyed their land since they came to the land until today.

Structure

Structure of Text A



Activity 1

Task 1

ACTIVITY I



Task 1 Think critically about the content of Text A and discuss the following questions in pairs.

1. In Paragraph 1 John Steinbeck thinks the early settlers approached the American continent savagely and thoughtlessly as if they hated it. To what extent could the land earn its hatred from the early settlers?
2. What land philosophy was manifested when those Americans acted like “travelers, moving about the country collecting its valuables, but with little idea of permanence; their roots and their hearts were in the towns and the growing cities along the eastern edge” (Paragraph 4)?
3. In what way were the new immigrants different from the early “travelers”? Why?
4. If you were cast into the wilderness as the early American settlers had been, would you deal with the virgin land of the New World in much the same way? Why or why not?
5. Modern Western industrial society was based on the following key values: happiness and well-being lie in the satisfaction of our material needs and sensual desires; the basic orientation of man to nature is one of conflict and struggle aimed at subjugation; nature must be conquered and made subservient to the satisfaction of our desires. What are the advantages and disadvantages of these values?
6. Many scholars today argue that the Chinese notion of “the unity of man and nature” (天人合一) provides the best remedy for environmental problems. Do you agree or disagree? Explain.

- The plants are in ruins including the forests, the grass and so on; the animals are also been swept such as buffalo.
 - The new immigrants are more addicted to the land and keep expanding their land as without bound, which make a more destructive result than the early "travelers".
 - Advantages:
The exploitation to nature make the development more swift and can satisfy the need of people. It can fasten the degree of welfare of human society.
Disadvantages:
It lack the consciousness of protecting the environment, which will undermine the condition of human's living. It will also destroy the sustainable development so that the resource descending more.
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President Trump's mindless tariffs will cause economic havoc

But the rest of the world can limit the damage

《The Economist》 2025.4.5

1. If you failed to spot America being “looted, pillaged, raped and plundered” by nations near and far” or it being cruelly denied a “turn to prosper”, then congratulations: you have a firmer grip on reality than the president of the United States. It’s hard to know which is more unsettling: that the leader of the free world could spout complete drivel about its most successful and admired economy. Or the fact that on April 2nd, spurred on by his delusions, Donald Trump announced the biggest break in America’s trade policy in over a century—and committed the most profound, harmful and unnecessary economic error in the modern era. *(Use the humorous language to introduce the topic of Donald Trump's trade policy)*
2. Speaking in the Rose Garden of the White House, the president announced new “reciprocal” tariffs on almost all America’s trading partners. There will be levies of 34% on China, 27% on India, 24% on Japan and 20% on the European Union. Many small economies face swingeing rates; all targets face a tariff of at least 10%. Including existing duties, the total levy on China will now be 65%. Canada and Mexico were spared additional tariffs, and the new levies will not be added to industry-specific measures, such as a 25% tariff on cars, or a promised tariff on semiconductors. But America’s overall tariff rate will soar above its Depression-era level back to the 19th century. *(The concrete trade policy of Trump that increase the tariff globally)*
3. Mr Trump called it one of the most important days in American history. He is almost right. His “Liberation Day” heralds America’s total abandonment of the world trading order and embrace of protectionism. The question for countries reeling from the president’s mindless vandalism is how to limit the damage. *(The announcement of Trump and its effects)*
4. Almost everything Mr Trump said this week—on history, economics and the technicalities of trade—was utterly deluded. His reading of history is upside down. He has long glorified the high-tariff, low-income-tax era of the late-19th century. In fact, the best scholarship shows that tariffs impeded the economy back then. He has now added the bizarre claim that lifting tariffs caused the Depression of the 1930s and that the Smoot-Hawley tariffs were too late to rescue the situation. The reality is that tariffs made the Depression much worse, just as they will harm all economies today. It was the painstaking rounds of trade talks in the subsequent 80 years that lowered tariffs and helped increase prosperity. *(State the fallacy of Trump's words recently)*

5. On economics Mr Trump's assertions are flat-out nonsense. The president says tariffs are needed to close America's trade deficit, which he sees as a transfer of wealth to foreigners. Yet as any of the president's economists could have told him, this overall deficit arises because Americans choose to save less than their country invests—and, crucially, this long-running reality has not stopped its economy from outpacing the rest of the G7 for over three decades. There is no reason why his extra tariffs should eliminate the deficit. Insisting on balanced trade with every trading partner individually is **bonkers**—like suggesting that Texas would be richer if it insisted on balanced trade with each of the other 49 states, or asking a company to ensure that each of its suppliers is also a customer. ***(The economists in America opposed the incorrect opinions on closing America's trade deficit)***
6. And Mr Trump's grasp of the technicalities was **pathetic**. He suggested that the new tariffs were based on an assessment of a country's tariffs against America, plus currency manipulation and other supposed **distortions**, such as value-added tax. But it looks as if officials set the tariffs using a formula that takes America's **bilateral** trade deficit as a share of goods imported from each country and halves it—which is almost as random as taxing you on the number of **vowels** in your name. ***(Criticize the nonsense method of Trump to determine the tariff)***
7. This catalogue of foolishness will bring needless harm to America. Consumers will pay more and have less choice. Raising the price of parts for America's manufacturers while relieving them of the discipline of foreign competition will make them **flabby**. As stockmarket futures **tumbled**, shares in Nike, which has factories in Vietnam (tariff: 46%) fell by 7%. Does Mr Trump really think Americans would be better off if only they sewed their own running shoes? ***(The negative effects of the wrong things determined by Trump to American manufacture)***
8. The rest of the world will share in the disaster—and must decide what to do. One question is whether to **retaliate**. Politicians should be cautious. Mr Trump, trade barriers harm those who put them up. Because they are more likely to cause Mr Trump to double down than retreat, they risk making things worse—possibly **catastrophically** so, as in the 1930s. ***(The negative effects of Trump's determination to the rest of the world)***
9. Instead, governments should focus on increasing trade flows among themselves, especially in the services that power the 21st-century economy. With a share of final demand for imports of only 15%, America does not dominate global trade the way it does global finance or military spending. Even if it halted imports entirely, on current trends 100 of its trading partners would have recovered all their lost exports within just five years, calculates Global Trade Alert, a think-tank. The EU, the 12 members of the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans Pacific Partnership (CPTPP), South Korea and small open economies like Norway account for 34% of global demand for imports. ***(Show the significance of increasing trade flows among the governments rather than just decreasing the import)***

10. Should this effort include China? Many in the West think that China's state-owned enterprises violate the spirit of global trading rules, and they have in the past used exports to **soak up surplus** capacity. Those worries will worsen if more Chinese goods are redirected away from America. Building a trading system with China is desirable, but will be **viable** only if it rebalances its economy towards domestic demand to ease worries about dumping. Also, China could be required to transfer technology and invest in production in Europe in exchange for lower tariffs. The EU should centralise its investment rules so that it can strike deals covering FDI and it should overcome its **aversion** to big trade pacts and sign up to the CPTPP, which has ways of resolving some disputes. **(Show the suspicion of the west to the effort of China)**
11. If this seems **gruelling** and slow, that is because integration always is. Throwing up barriers is easier and faster. There is no avoiding the havoc Mr Trump has **wrought**, but that does not mean his foolishness is destined to triumph. **(Emphasize the significance of global trade again and criticize Trump again)**
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Significant Words and Phrases

- loot **#CET6**
rob
- pillage
rob
- plunder
rob
- prosper **#CET6**
success
- spout
the mouth of pipe
- drivel
worthless message
- delusion **#CET6**
illusion
- reciprocal **#CET6**
mutual
- levy **#CET6**
impose and collect
- swingeing
extreme

- herald #CET6
foresee
- reel #CET6
confuse
- vandalism
destruction
- delude #CET6
deceive
- glorify
praise
- impede
interrupt; be an obstacle to
- bizarre #CET6
odd; unusual
- bonkers
mad
- pathetic #CET6
poor; pity
- distortion #CET6
a change for worse
- bilateral #CET6
having two sides
- vowel
a sound with the vocal tract open
- flabby
loose
- tumble #CET6
decrease
- retaliate #CET6
revenge
- catastrophic #CET6
extreme harmful
- soak up
absorb
- surplus #CET4 #CET6
a quantity larger than needed
- aversion #CET6
a feeling of dislike

- gruelling
suffering
- wrought
happened

Topic Idea

This article criticizes Trump's globally trade policy which will not only be harmful to America but also share the disaster with the rest of the world.

Structure

Structure of Text

